2B

GRAMMAR BANK

using adjectives as nouns, adjective order

adjectives as nouns

1 In most African countries, **the young** still look up to **the old**. 2.15
The poor are getting poorer, and **the rich** are getting richer.
The government needs to create more jobs for **the unemployed**.

2 **The English** are famous for drinking tea.
The Chinese invented paper.
The Dutch make wonderful cheeses.

- You can use *the* + some adjectives to talk about groups of people, e.g.

1 specific groups in society, such as *the young*, *the old* (or *the elderly*), *the sick* (= people who are ill), *the blind*, *the deaf*, *the homeless*, *the dead*.

2 some nationalities that end in *-ch*, *-sh*, *-ese*, and *-ss*, such as *the French*, *the Spanish*, *the British*, *the Japanese*, *the Irish*, *the Swiss*, etc. (most other nationality words are nouns and are used in the plural, e.g. *the Brazilians*, *the Poles*, *the Turks*, *the Hungarians*, *the Argentinians*, etc.).

- You can also use adjective + *people* to talk about a group of people, e.g. *poor people*, *homeless people*, *old people*, *French people*.
- To talk about one person, use, e.g. *a Japanese woman*, *a rich man*, etc. **NOT** ~~*a Japanese*~~, ~~*a rich*~~.

adjective order

We've got a **lovely old** cottage just outside Bath. 2.16
She has **long fair** hair.
I bought a **beautiful Italian leather** belt.

- You can put more than one adjective before a noun (often two and occasionally three). These adjectives go in a particular order, e.g. **NOT** ~~*an old lovely cottage*~~.
- Opinion adjectives, e.g. *beautiful*, *nice*, *lovely*, always go before descriptive adjectives, e.g. *big*, *old*, *round*.
- If there is more than one descriptive adjective, they go in this order:

OPINION	SIZE	AGE	SHAPE	COLOUR	PATTERN	ORIGIN / PLACE	MATERIAL	NOUN
expensive beautiful	little	brand new	long	purple	spotted	French Italian	silk	scarf car

a Rewrite the underlined phrase using *the* + an adjective.

People from Spain enjoy eating out. *The Spanish*

1 People from the Netherlands tend to be good at languages. The Dutch
2 Florence Nightingale looked after the people who weren't well during the Crimean War. The sick
3 The system of reading for people who can't see is called Braille. The blind
4 People from France think that their cuisine is the best in the world. The french
5 Ambulances arrived to take the people who had been injured to hospital. The injured
6 People from Switzerland are usually very punctual. The swiss
7 The worst season for people without a home is winter. The homeless
8 There is a discount for people without a job. The unemployed
9 The monument was erected to honour the people who died in the Second World War. The dead
10 There are special TV programmes for people who can't hear, which use sign language. The deaf

b Write the adjectives in brackets in the correct place. Change *a* to *an* where necessary.

a big car park (empty) *a big empty car park*

1 a man (young / attractive) an attractive young man
2 shoes (old / dirty) dirty old shoes
3 a velvet jacket (black / beautiful) a beautiful black velvet jacket
4 a girl (teenage / tall / American) a tall teenage American
5 a beach (sandy / long) a long beach
6 a country house (magnificent / 17th-century) magnificent 17th-century
7 a leather bag (Italian / stylish) stylish italian leather bag
8 eyes (huge / dark) huge dark eyes
9 a dog (black / friendly / old) a friendly old black dog
10 a T-shirt (striped / cotton) a striped cotton T-Shirt

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